

WEEK 9 – TUTORIAL

Objectives:

The objective of this tutorial is to provide students with a practical, interactive understanding of how leadership, governance, and alignment influence the success of IT projects. Through the case study of HealthPlus Insurance's cloud migration, students will critically analyse project challenges from multiple stakeholder perspectives, apply project management frameworks such as the Strategic Alignment Model, Balanced Scorecard, and Agile Value Streams, and develop skills in decision-making, teamwork, and strategic thinking. This tutorial aims to bridge theoretical knowledge and real-world application, enhancing students' ability to manage and align IT projects effectively within organizational contexts.

Tutorial Activities:

- Case study application.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this tutorial, students will be able to:

- **LO2.** Apply project management knowledge, tools and techniques
- **LO4.** Develop basic proficiency in project management tools and practices

Case Study application

Each group is assigned one role (IT Leader, Academic Staff, Steering Committee, Student Representative). Each group will answer the questions **from their stakeholder's perspective**.

The case study is as follows:

Cloud Migration at HealthPlus Insurance

HealthPlus Insurance, a mid-sized health insurance provider, decided to modernize its IT infrastructure by migrating its legacy claims processing system to a cloud-based platform. The goal was to improve scalability, reduce downtime, and enhance customer experience through faster claims approval.

The project involved multiple stakeholders:

- **Project Sponsor:** The CIO, who strongly advocated for digital transformation.
- **Steering Committee:** Comprised of executives from IT, operations, compliance, and customer service.
- **Project Team:** Developers, cloud engineers, and data specialists.
- **External Vendor:** A cloud service provider responsible for infrastructure setup.

Challenges soon emerged:

- **Leadership Issues:** The project manager was technically strong but lacked communication and motivational skills, leading to low morale among team members.
- **Governance Gaps:** The steering committee met irregularly, and decision-making about budget overruns and compliance requirements was delayed.

- **Alignment Problems:** IT focused on speed of migration, while operations and compliance were more concerned with data security and regulatory adherence. Misaligned priorities caused tensions between teams.

Despite these challenges, corrective steps were taken:

- A new **communication plan** was developed to ensure transparency with all stakeholders.
- Governance was strengthened by scheduling regular steering committee check-ins.
- Leadership training helped the project manager adopt a more adaptive leadership style.
- A **Balanced Scorecard** was introduced to align project goals with organizational strategy, ensuring that security, cost, and customer satisfaction were all considered.

In the end, the migration was completed three months later than expected but delivered improved performance, compliance adherence, and higher customer satisfaction ratings.

Questions:

1. Leadership: What leadership style would have worked better, and why?
Adaptive/Transformational Leadership would have been ideal. Focuses on inspiring and motivating the team while addressing individual needs. Encourages open communication, collaboration, and engagement across IT, operations, and compliance.
2. Governance: What governance structures/mechanisms were missing?
Steering Committee should have met regularly to approve key decisions monitor risks.
Project Sponsor involvement should have been more active to support alignment with organizational goals.
Clear escalation pathways and accountability were missing.
Risk and compliance oversight mechanisms (especially for data security and privacy) were weak.
3. Alignment: How was the project misaligned with the university's strategy?
IT focused on speed of migration and technical features, not the strategic goal of improving scalability, compliance, and customer experience.
Operations and compliance priorities (data security, regulatory adherence) were not integrated into project planning.
There was no formal framework to map project activities to strategic objectives, leading to tension and misalignment.
4. Integration: How do these three failures (leadership, governance, alignment) reinforce one another? This style helps the project manager bridge technical expertise with people management, reducing low morale and miscommunication.
Poor leadership → weak team motivation and unclear communication → exacerbates misalignment between IT and business goals.
Weak governance → delayed decisions and unmanaged risks → leadership cannot enforce direction effectively.

*Misalignment → conflicts over priorities → creates stress for the leader and challenges governance structures.
Combined effect: project delays, budget overruns, and suboptimal outcomes.*

Each group chooses **one framework** and applies it to *realign* the SmartCampus Project.

1. SAM → Which domains were broken and how to fix them?

Broken domains:

Business Strategy ↔ IT Strategy: IT focused on migration speed, not strategic goals like customer experience.

Organizational Infrastructure ↔ IT Infrastructure: Teams weren't coordinated; compliance and operations were sidelined.

Fixes:

Reassess IT initiatives against strategic goals.

Improve cross-functional communication between IT, operations, and compliance.

Map key performance indicators (KPIs) to both IT and business objectives.

2. BSC → What 4 metrics would you track for this project?

Metrics to track:

Financial: Project budget adherence, cost savings from cloud infrastructure.

Customer: Customer satisfaction with portal performance and claims approval time.

Internal Process: Downtime, system response times, error rate in claims processing.

Learning & Growth: Employee training completion, team skill improvement, adoption of cloud best practices.

3. Value Streams → How could the work be reorganized around delivering student value?

Reorganization approach:

Identify end-to-end value streams (e.g., "Claims Processing" or "Customer Support").

Organize cross-functional teams around each value stream.

Prioritize features and tasks based on value delivered to the customer (faster claim approval, secure processing).

Implement continuous feedback loops to ensure IT delivery aligns with business outcomes.